

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ T 7 3
 ♥ 8 6 5
 ♦ Q J T 4
 ♣ Q T 2

♠ A J 8 5

♥ K J

♦ A K 8

♣ K J 9 6



♠ 9 6

♥ 7 2

♦ 9 7 6 5 3 2

♣ A 5 3

♠ K Q 4 2

♥ A Q T 9 4 3

♦ -

♣ 8 7 4

West

North

East

South

2NT

Pass

3♣

Pass

3♠

Pass

6♠

All Pass

6♠ by North

North opens 2NT.

Wow! Start thinking slam, but first things first. Find the suit by starting with Stayman. You bid 3♣ and partner replies 3♠. What do you say next?

Your hand revalues to 16 points now that you know there's a ♠ fit. So certainly you want to be in slam as long as there are not two quick ♣ losers. At this point you might try something like a 4♦ cue bid, hoping partner will read that as a slam try in ♠s, but denying the ♣ control. But that seems awfully easy to be misunderstood. We suggest an immediate 6♠.

Good thing it's being played by North, right?

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ Q 7 4 2
♥ T 9 8 3
♦ J 8 7 6 3
♣ -

♠ J T 5

♥ Q J 7

♦ A K T 4

♣ J 6 5



♠ A 8 3

♥ A K 6 4

♦ Q 5 2

♣ Q 8 7

♠ K 9 6

♥ 5 2

♦ 9

♣ A K T 9 4 3 2

East opens 1NT.

Your first thought should be that with only 4 points you will pass. But on second thought, what would partner respond if you bid a Stayman 2♣? So you give it a shot and partner says 2♥. What next?

What's next is your PASS. And if he had bid 2♠ you also would have passed. And if he had bid 2♦ you also would have passed. You figured that with this hand any response partner could make would be a better place than 1NT.

West	North	East	South
		1NT	
2♣	Pass	2♥	Pass
All Pass			
2♥ by East			

Board 3

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ T 9 4 2

♥ T 7

♦ A T 4

♣ 7 6 5 4

♠ Q J 8 5

♥ K 6 4

♦ Q J 7

♣ K T 8



♠ 6

♥ Q J 8 3 2

♦ K 6 5 3

♣ J 9 3

♠ A K 7 3

♥ A 9 5

♦ 9 8 2

♣ A Q 2

South opens 1NT.

With 12 points and a 4-card ♠ suit this fits the model for Stayman.

But thinking a little further, with this 4-3-3-3 distribution you have no ruffing values whatsoever. So even if partner also has 4 ♠s there might not be an advantage in playing the suit contract. So for this specific distribution you ignore your 4-card Major and just bid 3NT.

West

North

East

South

1NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by South

Board 4

South Deals

Both Vul

♠ 9 8
 ♥ K J 4
 ♦ A Q J 7
 ♣ A T 8 5

♠ 3
 ♥ 9 8 6 5 3
 ♦ K 8 6 2
 ♣ 6 3 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A Q T 6
 ♥ Q 7
 ♦ T 9 5
 ♣ K 9 7 4

♠ K J 7 5 4 2
 ♥ A T 2
 ♦ 4 3
 ♣ Q J

West	North	East	South
1NT	Pass	2♣	Pass
Pass	Pass	3NT	2♠
All Pass			
3NT by West			

After you open 1NT partner bids 2♣, then South says 2♠. What do you say next?

Basically you said your say when you opened 1NT. You don't have a 4-card Major and you have a minimum hand. The best way to convey this information to partner is to pass. At which point partner jumps to 3NT.

Pass, then "Thank you partner" when dummy comes down. The thing to remember is that partner is in charge. You describe your hand as well as you can and then sit back and let him make the decisions. Perhaps you would have doubled if you held his hand but he didn't.

Board 5

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 6 3
 ♥ 9 8 5 2
 ♦ 9 5
 ♣ J T 9 6

♠ A 8

♥ K J 7 4

♦ A 7 2

♣ K Q 5 3



♠ J 7 5 4

♥ 6

♦ K Q J T 8 4

♣ A 2

♠ K Q T 2

♥ A Q T 3

♦ 6 3

♣ 8 7 4

West

North

East

South

1NT

2♦

3♦

Pass

3♥

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by North

makes a fit. You have 12 revalued points so you bid 4♥.

North opens 1NT and East overcalls 2♦.

Dad-burned interfering opponents. You were going to bid a Stayman 2♣ and now you can't. You also don't want to bid either Major with only 4 of them. And you certainly can't bid notrump with no ♦ stopper. Fortunately the overcall has opened a window of opportunity for you. So you cue-bid 3♦. Even if you and partner haven't discussed this it is pretty obvious that you don't really want to play in ♦s, so the most likely action for him is to bid a suit, and a Major suit would have priority. So really, the cue-bid achieves the same purpose as Stayman would have.

Partner now bids 3♥.

Partner showed a 4-card ♥ suit. With your 4 that